Modi was now addressing as many as six rallies a day, focused on the three remaining states of UP, Bihar and Bengal. The advertising campaign was intensified, with the frequency of the ads being increased. Every few minutes, a TV screen in one of the poll-bound states would have Modi staring at the camera, touching his heart emblazoned with a BJP badge, and saying, *'Aapka diya gaya vote seedhe mujhe ayega'* (Your vote will come directly to me). 'We wanted to make the candidates irrelevant—this was now only about Modi for PM,' is how a BJP strategist described the presidential-style campaign thrust.

To try and ensure that their leader touched almost every battleground constituency, Team Modi played their final *Brahmastra*—Modi in 3D. The idea had originated in the 2012 Gujarat assembly election campaign. That election, like so much else in Team Modi's 2014 strategy, served as a laboratory for innovative ideas. The 3D technology had been patented by a UK-based company, Musion. The India rights were acquired and a team of 200 foreign and Indian technicians worked for almost six months to perfect the broadcast. It was first attempted in December 2012 when Modi's fifty-five-minute speech made from his political base in Gandhinagar was broadcast in fifty-three locations across twenty-six cities. 'We were able to cover lakhs of people across thousands of kilometres in one go. It had a terrific impact,' says Prashant Kishore of CAG who headed the team which planned the concept.

I watched one of the 3D shows during the 2012 Gujarat elections from just outside Vadodara. Gujaratis, like most Indians, love their cinema. This was like a political movie being played out in front of them, with Modi as the star. Just the technology which showed Modi appearing with a glow around him was enough to make the crowd feel this was 'paisa *vasool*'. Some members in the audience would move towards the screen, trying to touch Modi, and then scream excitedly when they realized this was only a cinematic image of their leader.

Now, in the general elections, the Gujarat experiment was taken nationwide. While in April, Modi would do a 3D rally once every three to four days, in the last stretch, he was doing nearly one a day. As a result, he